

The food of Indonesia

A Vocabulary preview

Find the words in the text and match them with the definitions.

- | | |
|-------------------------------|--|
| 1 farming (n) | a the substance on the surface of the Earth in which plants grow |
| 2 food stall (n) | b food changed from its natural state |
| 3 groceries (n) | c growing crops or producing animal products |
| 4 herbs and spices (n) | d things used to add flavor to food |
| 5 industry (n) | e to put trees, seeds, etc. in the ground to grow |
| 6 plant (v) | f the food you regularly buy in a store |
| 7 processed food (n) | g a large table or a small building that is open at the front, used for selling food |
| 8 soil (n) | h the people and organizations involved in producing goods |

B Before you read

Previewing a text

Look at the picture and heading. What is the text's purpose?

- To give an overview of the Indonesian food industry
- To compare the Indonesian food industry with food in the rest of the world

C Global reading

Completing a summary of main ideas

Summaries give an overview of the main ideas in a text. Read the topic sentences and identify the supporting information and important words to help you summarize the main ideas.

- 1 Skim *The food of Indonesia* and check (✓) the things that are mentioned in the text.

challenges in the past challenges today changes to diet and shopping
changes to jobs local dishes money for farmers plants and crops

- 2 Use your answers from Exercise 1 to complete a summary of the text.

Indonesia has a lot of rain and sunshine and produces different¹_____. These traditionally influence the food and a lot of herbs and spices are used in²_____. However,³_____ and⁴_____ habits are changing. Today people eat more processed foods. People often buy groceries in local stores, but they also use supermarkets. One of the main⁵_____ for the food industry⁶_____ is the increasing population. It means more foods have to be imported.

The food of Indonesia

- 1 Situated in a warm, tropical region, Indonesia has a lot of rain and sunshine and therefore has the perfect climate for a long growing season. The country also has large areas of good-quality soil. Both factors make Indonesia an excellent region for a successful farming economy. A large percentage of the population works in the farming industry and the country gets a lot of income from this. There is a large range of farms, but most belong to three types: small farms growing rice for domestic use, small farms growing crops for export, and large, foreign-owned or privately-owned farms that also mostly export food.
- 2 Indonesia's climate makes it ideal for planting and growing most popular crops. Indonesia is one of the world's largest producers of many different kinds of food. It is a known producer of palm oil and spices like cloves and cinnamon. It is also one of the biggest producers of other key foods consumers frequently buy such as cocoa, coffee, and tea. Growing plants to eat is obviously important, yet many farmers also plant other crops of high value such as natural rubber.
- 3 The farming industry is clearly important for the country's economy, however, it has also influenced the local food culture and customs. Indonesia has a long history of cooking with herbs and spices. The Betawi, who are a local

group in the region of Jakarta, are responsible for many of the street foods. Kerak Telor, which is possibly their most famous dish, is made of rice, coconut, onions, shrimp, and egg and fried into a cake. With thousands of street food stalls selling dishes for under one U.S. dollar they form an important part of the economy.

- 4 As Indonesia has become richer and more urban the local diets have gradually changed. In particular, the amount of dairy, meat, and sugar people eat has grown. Many of these products and other processed foods and drink are often imported. A lot of people still prefer to shop in traditional local stores for their groceries, but supermarkets are selling an increasing amount of food to urban people. These stores mostly sell processed foods and often have better refrigerators to keep the dairy and meat products people demand.
- 5 As lifestyles and diets change there are many challenges facing the Indonesian food industry. In the past, the country produced enough rice and sugar for everyone, but now it needs to import these foods. An increasing population, more land being used for crops people do not eat, and growing industries are all placing pressure on the future of food in Indonesia.

GLOSSARY

imported (adj) brought into your country from another country

rubber (n) a strong material made from a tree and that bends easily

Man frying Kerak Telor.

Scanning

D Close reading

Read the text again. Write *T* (True), *F* (False), or *NG* (Not Given) for each sentence.

- 1 Very few people now work in farming in Indonesia. ____
- 2 Indonesia does not produce any meat products. ____
- 3 Herbs and spices are quite new in Indonesian cooking. ____
- 4 People now eat more processed foods. ____
- 5 Indonesia can produce all of the rice and sugar it needs today. ____

E Critical thinking

Discuss these questions in a group.

- 1 What changes in diet have there been in Indonesia? Have you had similar changes in diet in your country?

The diet in Indonesia has changed to ...

The diet in my country ...

- 2 Why do you think people eat more processed foods today? What health problems might it cause?

People's diets have changed because ...

Eating more processed foods can cause ...